

Military Support

Although the transport aircraft and trainers may not look like the most advanced aircraft of the 1970s, the decade nevertheless spawned a wide range of new types aimed at military support. Many of them are still in service—and even still in production—40 years later. Some of the jet trainers were so good that they doubled as light attack aircraft and served well in combat in subsequent decades.



◁ Let L-410 Turbolet 1970

Origin Czechoslovakia
Engine 2 x 740 hp Walter M-601B turboprop
Top speed 227 mph (365 km/h)

A short-range transport aircraft used mostly for passenger transport in Eastern Bloc countries but since remarketed worldwide. The L-410 is still in service after detailed upgrades in subsequent decades.



◁ BAC Jet Provost T4 1970

Origin UK
Engine 2,500 lb (1,134 kg) thrust Armstrong Siddeley ASV7 Viper turbojet
Top speed 440 mph (708 km/h)

Percival developed the Jet Provost in the 1950s. In the 1960s, BAC built the more powerful T4, and through the 1970s, it was a popular, reliable RAF trainer capable of aerobatics and weapons training.



△ Aeritalia G.222 1970

Origin Italy
Engine 2 x 3,400 hp General Electric T64-GE-P4D turboprop
Top speed 336 mph (540 km/h)

Designed by Fiat to meet a NATO specification for vertical and/or short takeoff and landing (V/STOL) transport aircraft, G.222 entered production for Italy's armed forces and was adopted by customers worldwide; 111 were built.



△ Aero L-39 Albatros 1971

Origin Czechoslovakia
Engine 3,792 lb (1,720 kg) thrust Ivchenko AI-25TL turbopfan
Top speed 466 mph (750 km/h)

This is a high-performance two-seat jet trainer with light attack capability, designed by Jan Vlcek. The Czech-built L-39 has served with more than 30 air forces, mostly from former Eastern Bloc countries.



◁ AESL CT/4 Airtrainer 1972

Origin New Zealand
Engine 210 hp Teledyne Continental IO-360-HB9 air-cooled flat-6
Top speed 264 mph (424 km/h)

This side-by-side two-seater was designed for basic military training and is fully aerobatic. Popular in service with the New Zealand, Australian, and Thai air forces, it was replaced with an updated model.



◁ Dassault-Breguet/Dornier Alpha Jet 1973

Origin France/Germany
Engine 2 x 2,976 lb (1,350 kg) thrust SNECMA Turbomeca Larzac O4-C5 turbopfan
Top speed 621 mph (1,000 km/h)

Developed jointly, primarily as a light attack jet for Germany and an advanced trainer for France, the Alpha Jet was a market competitor to British Aerospace's Hawk; 480 were sold worldwide.



▷ Dassault Falcon 10MER 1975

Origin France
Engine 2 x 3,230 lb (1,465 kg) thrust Garrett TFE731-2 turbopfan
Top speed 566 mph (912 km/h)

The French Navy commissioned Dassault to supply a small number of specially adapted business jets for training, electronic countermeasures, communications, and transport services, which emerged as the Falcon 10MER.

